INTERPRETIVE STUDY / 2026 / SHOWCASE EDITION

Reading folded landscapes across the Kurdistan Region

Geo-Kurdistan editorial study group

Structural geology | Erbil and Sulaymaniyah governorates

Review status: Pending teacher review. This mock editorial publication supports teacher feedback on the showcase. It is not a published scientific study.

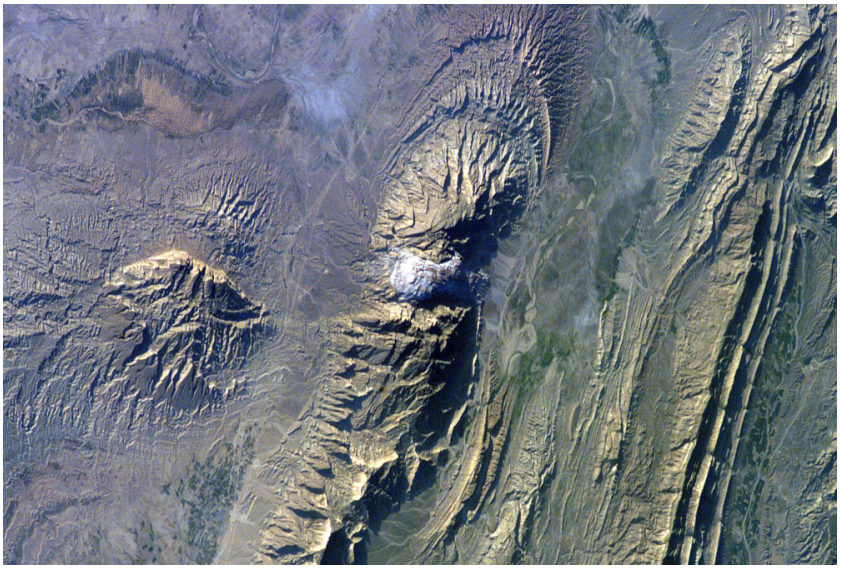
Abstract

A showcase reading pathway linking mountain-scale form, exposed bedding and field-scale structural evidence.

01 / From landform to evidence

Folded landscapes are easiest to understand when observation and interpretation remain separate. Ridge shape, bedding traces and valley orientation are visible evidence; the sequence of tectonic events is an interpretation that must be supported by mapping and measured sections.

The showcase uses this distinction to help public visitors ask useful questions without presenting an attractive landscape photograph as a complete geological explanation.



Regional fold pattern from orbit

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02 / Reading structure across scales

At regional scale, repeated elongated ridges suggest a structural grain. At canyon scale, bedding can be followed across slopes. At specimen scale, smaller folds reveal how competent layers responded to compression.

None of these scales replaces the others. Their value comes from linking observations while retaining each record's provenance and uncertainty.



Fold geometry at specimen scale

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03 / What field checks add

Orientation measurements, lithological logs and verified formation contacts test interpretations made from distant views. Photographs should retain location, direction and scale so a later reader can understand what was actually observed.

For the teacher-review stage, the platform deliberately labels formation assignments and geological ages as provisional where the source material is not yet sufficient.



Observation before interpretation

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04 / A public reading pathway

Visitors can begin with the landscape, move to mapped places, compare related records and then open research that explains the method. This pathway is more useful than placing every technical field in the first view.

References and editorial limits

Showcase editorial synthesis

Mock publication created to review navigation, evidence labels and regional relationships.

Imagery

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